

# Blaize Giangiulio

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## CONTACT INFORMATION

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## EDUCATION

**Drexel University**, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania USA  
Ph.D. Candidate, Economics, September 2024–Present (Expected graduation date: June 2027)  
Ph.D. Student, Economics, August 2022–September 2024  
Advisor: Yoto V. Yotov  
Completed Ph.D. coursework in international trade (theory and empirics), industrial organization, and econometrics  
  
**McGill University**, Montreal, Quebec CAN  
M.A., Economics, August 2021  
Specialized in international trade under Ngo Van Long; completed additional advanced coursework in computational economics and forecasting  
B.A., Economics, May 2020

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

International trade: gravity modeling, sanctions, elasticity measurement, labor-market effects, and integration of geospatial modeling  
  
Industrial organization: warranties, insurance policies, hidden attributes, and add-on pricing

## WORKING PAPERS

*“Chokepoints”* **2026**  
Solo-authored  
Develop a structural model of strategic maritime chokepoint disruption in an  $(N + 1)$ -country Armington trade economy. Show that an agitator can rationally disrupt rival trade corridors by exploiting terms-of-trade gains that increase with corridor size. Derive an augmented structural gravity system—standard structural gravity closed by an optimality condition for the disrupted multilateral resistances—and an augmented ACR welfare decomposition that isolates a strategic terms-of-trade channel. Apply the model to the Red Sea crisis using dyad-specific rerouting intensities constructed from a global network of 6,000 cities, estimating trade elasticities with a PPML event study and quantifying the general-equilibrium incidence of the disruption.

*“Transportation Choke Points, Trade, and Logistic Distance”* **2025–2026**  
Joint with Peter Herman, Serge Shikher, and Yoto V. Yotov  
Constructs a novel transportation-network-informed distance variable that incorporates realistic city-to-city routing into the Mayer and Zignago (2011) population-weighted distance formula, rendering bilateral distances responsive to infrastructure shocks. Applies the measure to the 2023 Red Sea crisis as a natural experiment, estimating a saturated gravity model in an event-study framework on monthly bilateral trade data.

*“Automotive Tariffs, Spillover Effects, and the Used Car Market”* **2025–2026**  
Joint with Sébastien Bradley, Mian Dai, and Yoto V. Yotov  
Constructs a dynamically web-scraped dataset of approximately nine million U.S. used vehicle listings (April–October 2025) to study how automotive import tariffs propagate into the secondary

vehicle market, using an event-study design around the 2025 tariff announcement and implementation dates and comparing price dynamics by country of manufacture and by brand origin.

*“Time-Varying Distance and Trade”*

**2025–2026**

Joint with Peter Herman, Serge Shikher, and Yoto V. Yotov

Extends the Mayer and Zignago (2011) population-weighted distance formula to allow bilateral distances to fluctuate over time using annual city-level population data from the mid-twentieth century onward, and analyzes within a gravity framework how long-run shifts in the spatial distribution of population have shaped bilateral trade patterns.

**HONORS AND  
AWARDS**

Drexel University: Fellow at the Center for Global Policy Analysis, 2025–Present; Dr. Tom Hindelang Outstanding Ph.D. Student Instructor Award, 2025; Drexel Teaching Assistant Excellence Award, 2024; Dragon Fellowship (\$2,500 per annum), 2022–Present

McGill University: Awarded Master’s Teaching Assistantship, 2020–2021;  
Graduated with Distinction, 2020; Principal Student-Athlete Honour Roll, 2017

**TEACHING  
EXPERIENCE**

**Drexel University**, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania USA

*Course Instructor*

**September 2024–Present**

Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 201): Fall 2024 and Fall 2025; Ph.D. Math Camp: Summer 2025; Intermediate Microeconomics (ECON 301): Spring 2026

*Teaching Assistant*

**August 2022–Present**

Facilitated restructuring of introductory microeconomics course for large-section formats, conducted office hours, graded, and ran occasional lectures

**McGill University**, Montreal, Quebec CAN

*Teaching Assistant*

**August 2020–May 2021**

Ran weekly recitations for introductory macroeconomics course and fielded questions in an online discussion forum

**RESEARCH  
EXPERIENCE**

**Drexel University**, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania USA

*Fellow at the Center for Global Policy Analysis*

**May 2025–Present**

Worked on the development of a large-scale EQUIP trade simulation model, developed a geospatially founded logistical distance measurement, and designed and executed distributed estimation pipelines using HPC clusters (Slurm), scaling to 5,000+ PPML regressions with high-dimensional fixed effects

*Research Assistant*

**December 2022–Present**

Worked as an RA for Dr. Yotov, processing, analyzing, and trimming data from an extensive range of trade-relevant sources in R and Stata; wrote reports on and summarized trade-related policy papers

**U.S. International Trade Commission**, Washington, DC USA

*Student Trainee (Economist)*

**July 2024–March 2025**

Worked on a research project on the impact of population movements on international trade flows in the structural gravity framework; employed cutting-edge geospatial data and graph theory methods in Python to predict shipping routes between coordinate pairs and generate a new logistical distance variable; provided technical assistance to USTR

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| OTHER EXPERIENCE | <b>Acentus Practice Management</b> , Mount Laurel, New Jersey USA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|                  | <i>Billing and Claims Analyst (Intern)</i> <b>August 2021–May 2022</b><br>Streamlined the healthcare billing process and sought to identify and remedy idiosyncrasies in denied payments for a major South Jersey medical network                                                                                                         |
|                  | <b>Que Zhi Ling School</b> , Montreal, Quebec CAN                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|                  | <i>Primary School Math Teacher</i> <b>April 2020–August 2020</b><br>Taught primary school mathematics for a francophone private summer academy in Montreal                                                                                                                                                                                |
| REFEREE SERVICE  | Referee for <i>Defence and Peace Economics</i> , 2026<br>Referee for <i>Economics Letters</i> , 2024 and 2025<br>Referee for <i>Review of International Economics</i> , 2024<br>Referee for <i>The World Economy</i> , 2024                                                                                                               |
| RELEVANT SKILLS  | <i>Programming</i> : Stata, Python (Selenium), R, MATLAB<br><i>Computing/Tools</i> : Bash, Slurm (HPC job arrays), L <sup>A</sup> T <sub>E</sub> X<br><i>Languages</i> : English (Native) and French (Fluent)<br><i>Methods</i> : Gravity modeling: estimation and GE analysis; use of geospatial data in Python; time-series forecasting |
| ADDITIONAL       | Presented “Transportation Choke Points, Trade, and Logistic Distance” at Philadelphia Trade Group meeting (2025)<br>Participated in Drexel Sanctions Workshop (2024)<br>Took course in differential equations from Camden County College (Fall 2021)<br>HIAS Refugee Welcome Center Volunteer (2018)<br>Eagle Scout                       |